

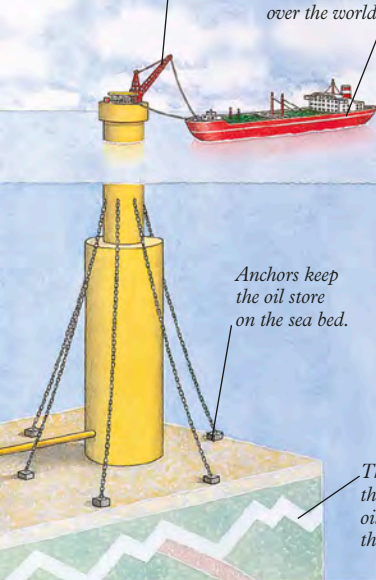
Only way out

A 769-mile-long (1,287-kilometer-long) pipe snakes across the snowy wastes of Alaska. Oil takes a whole week to flow down the pipe to reach an ice-free port in the South.



Huge tankers “plug into” this oil store to take on oil.

Tankers can take oil all over the world.



Anchors keep the oil store on the sea bed.

This zigzag break in the picture is to show that oil is usually found under thousands of yards of rock.



Wildcat wanted?

Before a well is dug, geologists must be sure that the rocks below the ground are the right shape to trap oil. A test drill, or “wildcat,” is only started if the surveys and satellite pictures look good.

Oil at sea

Huge structures, called rigs, drill down to find oil. At sea, some rigs float on the surface, while others stand on the sea bed.



Look how big this rig is compared to the Statue of Liberty!



Jack-up rig



Drill ship



Semisubmersible rig



Pump it up

Not all oil gushes to the surface naturally. Some is pumped up by machines called nodding donkeys! This “donkey” has been painted to look like a grasshopper.

Gas gushes out when the pressure is released.



Bubble trouble

Just like the fizz in soda pop, bubbles of natural gas are trapped in oil. If there is enough gas, it is piped ashore. If not, the gas is just burned.

